If it refuses to ping, but uses its LEDs to claim that it's online and functioning properly, reset it a couple of times and try pinging it about 10 minutes after it comes online again, from both wireless and wired clients. If that fails, either you can check and recheck its configuration settings, and compare them to the setting of a working access point, or you could use a sledge hammer to finally see what the insides of an access point look like, unless it's still under warranty, of course.

This scenario is rare though, as most often it is a bad configuration job that spoils the day.

If the wired LAN can communicate with the access point, but the wireless devices refuse to do so, you need to first test signal strengths. You can use NetStumbler, one of the utilities mentioned in the previous chapter, Security, to do this. If the signal strength is bad, check the access point's antenna, and move it about to look for improvements; consider changing the antenna if this does not work. If the signal strength is good, and still the wireless clients refuse to connect, try changing the channel on which the access point operates, and make the same change for one of the wireless clients that couldn't connect earlier. If this let's the client connect, you have an interference problem. If not, change the channel back to the original value and check the SSID once again.

The next step is to check and recheck the WEP configuration. Make sure that all the WEP settings on the access point and the test client are identical-the encryption level (40, 64 or 128-bit). Try changing the WEP settings on both the access point and the wireless test client and see if that helps.

The next step is to check for a mismatched configuration of DHCP. If your client is set to use a static IP and your access point set to let clients connect and assign IPs using DHCP, the client will not be able to ping the access point (as in our example problem here). So make sure that both, client and access point, are set to use either DHCP or fixed IPs. Some access points have an inbuilt